



OFFICIAL

Clerical Admission Procedure

1. Scope

Site	Operational Area	Applicable to
Armada Health Service	Health Information Management Service	Clerical

2. Purpose

This procedure describes the clerical admission process for inpatient admissions.

3. Procedure

The admitting clerk is responsible for capturing and recording accurate patient information in the Patient Administration System (webPAS) and obtaining signatures on relevant Admission Forms (i.e. Financial Election and Claim Type Forms).

Refer to [webPAS Process Guides](#) for step-by-step training materials.

3.1 Patient Master Index (PMI) and Financial Election.

- Verify patient demographic information and update webPAS PMI as required. Use *Admission Comments* field for any follow-up needed to ensure data accuracy. This field should be used if information cannot be obtained at the time of admission from either the patient or their Next of Kin (NOK).
- Confirm if the patient has been admitted to another hospital within WA in the last 7 days. WebPAS only provides details of previous admissions to a public hospital. If applicable record the previous admission dates during processing the patient admission.
- Sight two forms of identification, preferably one with a photo and the patient's Medicare card.
- For non-Medicare patients obtain a copy of the patient's passport and travel insurance details (including Insurer Name, Member Number).
- Provide the patient with a copy of the '*Information for Patients*' sheet, to support informed decision regarding financial election.
- Ask the patient if they have 'Private Health Insurance relevant to this admission'.
 - If NO the financial election is to be entered according to admission.
 - If YES and the patient elects to be admitted as a private patient, obtain private health fund details (fund name, fund level and membership number).
 - If patient has private health insurance but chooses not to use it, record this decision in the comments field on webPAS.

Before referencing this procedure document please ensure that you have the latest version from the [Policy Library](#) information hub page.

- Update PMI with Health Fund details.
- If the patient or their family require further information, or are unable to make a decision, contact the Private Patient Liaison Officer (PPLO). Unless advised by PPLO record the financial election on webPAS as *Public* (with valid Medicare Card).
- Admit patient on webPAS
- Print Claim Type Forms from webPAS and obtain patient signatures. If the patient has elected to use their private health insurance, ensure the *Informed Consent Form* is also signed. Refer to [Financial election tip sheet with flowchart.pdf](#) for further information.
- For compensable patients (excluding than Public or Veterans Affairs), scan the signed Claim Type Form, HC21 and Informed Consent Form to **AHS.Cplo@health.wa.gov.au**. Signed forms to be scanned into the DMR on discharge.
- Print 1 x patient ID label for the end of bed notes.

Refer to the **webPAS PMI standards** for full information regarding naming conventions and when to register stillborn. [webPAS-PMI-Standards](#)

Mental Health clerks are to confirm patient details with NOK if patient unable to provide information. Refer to [Patient Financial Election Mental Health](#) procedure.

3.2 Direct Admissions

Direct admissions are usually from another hospital or treating facility. They are NOT via the Emergency Department or waitlist.

- Admitting clerk will be aware of new admissions either by notification of clinical staff, or by checking Enterprise Bed Management (EBM).
- Obtain admission details from clinical staff including the admitting doctor, room and bed allocation and diagnosis.

3.3 Booked/Waitlist Admission

Booked/waitlist admissions apply when a patient is scheduled in advance for a known issue/procedure. They are NOT via the Emergency Department or direct admissions.

- Review theatre list and admit patients in order of operation times (one patient per list within each 30min block e.g. 630-7am, 7-730am).
- Confirm whether the patient is planned as a same day or overnight stay. Ensure this information is accurately entered into webPAS, as this field determines if a NaCS discharge summary is generated/ required.

Surgical waitlist patient claim types cannot be changed without approval from the Surgeon. Surgeon must provide patient with estimated fees and charges prior to the patient accepting.

3.4 Emergency Department Admissions

Emergency Department (ED) clerks are responsible for processing patient admissions from ED to the inpatient wards.

- ED clerk is responsible for reviewing Enterprise Bed Management (EBM) to identify any patient bed requests from the Emergency Department.
- Clerk to record relevant information from EBM into the Emergency Department Information System (EDIS).
- Nursing staff will provide admission paperwork to clerk. The Clerk is to verify the admitting consultant based on the patient's speciality before processing the admission.
- When patient is prepared for transfer to the ward, the ED clerk is to complete the admission in webPAS in accordance with the *Admission for ED guidelines*. The designated ward and bed number will be displayed on EBM. PCA is paged and patient is transferred to the ward.

3.5 Recurring Care Admissions

Recurring care admissions apply when a patient is admitted to the hospital on a regular basis for the same condition. This may include staged procedures or ongoing treatment such as dialysis.

- **Initial Admission Requirement**

Patients must first have an acute admission recorded in webPAS, recurring care admissions are then processed using the recurring care function.

- **Recurring Care Function**

To utilise the recurring care function a valid admission must be available to copy. This admission must:

- Be a same-day episode.
- Contain the same ward, clinician, unit and contact details. All admission details will be copied to the recurring care admission.

- **Dialysis Admissions:**

Dialysis admissions are processed according to dialysis session times. Refer to Dialysis Ward Clerk Duties on W:Drive for more information.

- Confirm with patient/family their health insurance covers them for the recurring care episode (Dialysis).
- Admission Procedure is to be completed monthly for dialysis patients who attend weekly.

3.6 Newborn Registrations

Newborn registrations (creation of UMRN) are only for babies born that have never been registered in webPAS.

When registering newborns in the hospital where the birth occurred, the webPAS Mother-Child Link' is automatic.

All newborns should be registered under the mother's surname on webPAS via the mother's Inpatient Visit except for stillborn babies.

Newborns must be registered in accordance with webPAS PMI Standards as per below:

- Surname field: Mother's surname e.g. JONES
- First Given Name field: Mothers UMRN, space, mother's first name in brackets e.g. (K0000001 CATHERINE)

Multiple birth registrations are noted in webPAS by entering Multiple Birth Attribute Type and Birth Order. The format for registering is as follows:

- Twins Surname field: Mother's surname
- First given name field: (Twin number, space, mother's UMRN, space, mother's first name) in brackets e.g. (TW ONE K0000000 DEANNE)

Refer to the **webPAS PMI standards** for full information regarding naming conventions and when to register stillborn. [webPAS-PMI-Standards](#)

- Admitting Clerk to admit newborns in webPAS as per [webPAS Input Newborn instructions](#) (if birth episode).
- Obtain admission information from clinical staff: Admitting Dr, room/bed number and diagnosis.
- Newborn financial election will be the same as the mothers.
- Patient ID labels for the end of bed notes.
 - The baby labels are highlighted with either blue or pink (depending on baby's gender) vertical line alongside edge of each column of labels.
 - For Twin 2 add 2 vertical highlighted lines

3.6 Newborn Admissions

Newborn admissions are for newborns admitted due to a health issue (not the birth registration) and are processed as an acute admission.

- Ward Clerk to admit newborns in webPAS as per [webPAS Direct Admission instructions](#)
- Obtain admission information from clinical staff: Admitting Doctor, room/bed number and diagnosis.
- Newborn financial election will be the same as the mothers.
- Patient ID labels for the end of bed notes.
 - The baby labels are highlighted with either blue or pink (depending on baby's gender) vertical line alongside edge of each column of labels.
 - For Twin 2 add 2 vertical highlighted lines

4. Supporting information

The following documents support the implementation of this procedure:

- [webPAS Process Guides](#)
- [webPAS PMI Standards](#)
- [Financial election tip sheet with flowchart.pdf](#)
- [Admitted Patient Activity Data Business Rules](#)

5. Relevant standards

National Safety and Quality Health Service (NSQHS) Standards (second edition):

Standard 1 – Action 1.16: The health service organisation has healthcare record systems that:

- Make the healthcare record available to clinicians at the point of care

- Support the workforce to maintain accurate and complete healthcare records
- Comply with security and privacy regulations
- Support systematic audit of clinical information
- Integrate multiple information systems, where they are used

Standard 6 – Action 6.5: The health service organisation:

- Defines approved identifiers for patients according to best-practice guidelines
- Requires at least three approved identifiers on registration and admission; when care, medication, therapy, and other services are provided; and when clinical handover, transfer or discharge documentation is generated.

6. Policy contact

Director Operations and Corporate Operations

Enquiries relating to this procedure may be directed to:

Title: Manager
 Department: Health Information Management Services
 Email: AHS.HIMSManager@health.wa.gov.au

7. Review

This procedure will be reviewed and evaluated as required to ensure relevance and currency. At a minimum it will be reviewed within one (1) year after first issue and at least every three (3) years thereafter.

Version	Effective from	Effective to	Amendment(s)
V2	17 12 2025	17 12 2028	Full Review: flow of information and broken links updated.

8. Authorisation

This procedure has been authorised and issued by:

Authorised By	Director Operations and Corporate Operations – Michael Morton
Authorisation Date	17 12 2025
Published Date	17 12 2025